The Sara Morning

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 BACKFILLED EDITION 12 stories · 16 sources

1 source articles could not be read today; those stories show headlines and links only.

THREE THINGS TO KNOW

1. Experts urge COP31 to prioritize climate breakdown, public health, and nuclear risks over military spending.
2. A new study shows that rising seas and coastal development threaten 89% of iconic surf breaks worldwide.
3. Record high heating oil prices in the Northeast are straining household budgets and driving up early assistance demand.

Advocates Urge COP31 to Confront Climate Breakdown, Health, and Nuclear Risks

Ahead of COP31 in Turkey, experts argue global security priorities must pivot from military spending to addressing public health crises, climate breakdown, and nuclear dangers.

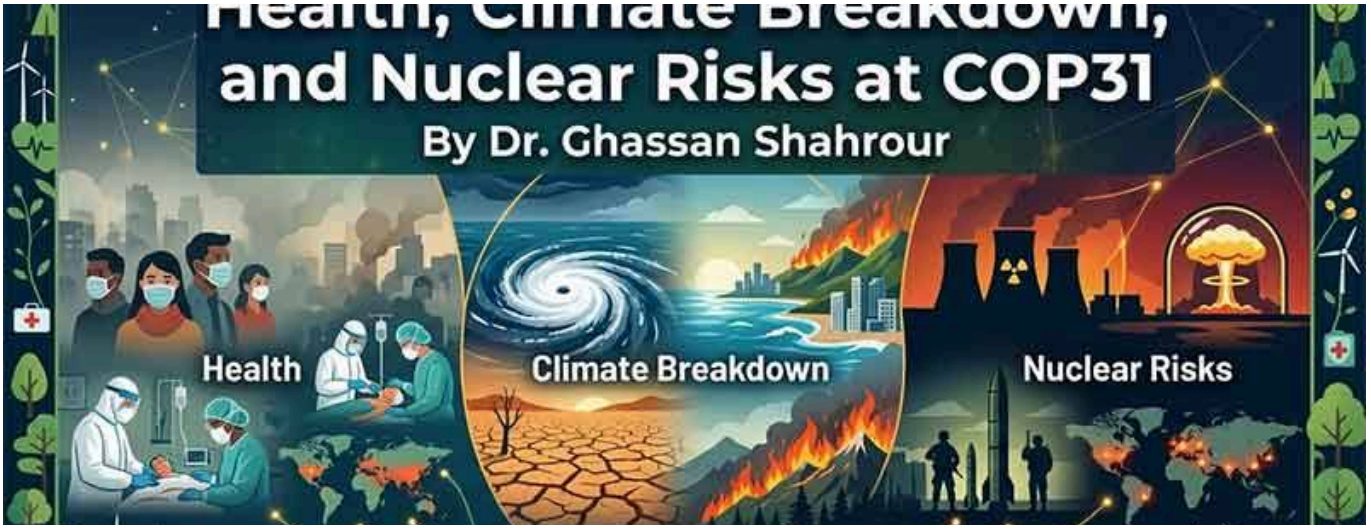
- Heat-related deaths worldwide have reached over half a million each year following decades of worsening climate impacts. [countercurrents.org]
  > "heat related mortality has risen by 23 percent since the 1990s, reaching approximately 546000 deaths annually."
- Global defense budgets rose to nearly $2.9 trillion in 2025, underscoring questions about investment priorities amid worsening climate and public health needs. [countercurrents.org]
  > "world military expenditure reached 2.887 trillion dollars in 2025, an increase of 2.9 percent over the previous year."
- Medical and emergency infrastructures lack the capacity to deliver an effective response in the event of a nuclear blast. [countercurrents.org]
  > "Health systems would be unable to respond effectively to a nuclear detonation."
- Advocates call on COP31 negotiators to broaden traditional security definitions to incorporate health and nuclear risk mitigation. [countercurrents.org]
  > "COP31 should help challenge this contradiction by placing human health, climate resilience, peace, and nuclear risk reduction within a broader vision"

In the image: The graphic identifies Dr. Ghassan Shahrour as author and illustrates the summit themes with depictions of medical workers, droughts, wildfires, and a nuclear mushroom cloud.

✓ 4 of 4 claims verified against sources · 1 source

countercurrents.org

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CLIMATE CHANGE



Climate Change Threatens 89% of Iconic Surf Breaks Worldwide

A new study reveals that rising seas and coastal development put famous waves at risk across the globe.

- A recent peer-reviewed study published in Climatic Change evaluated 57 internationally significant surf breaks across eight countries. [downtoearth.org.in]

  > "A new peer-reviewed study published in Climatic Change assessed 57 internationally significant surf breaks across eight countries."

- The research found that 89 percent of iconic surf breaks face risks regarding their shoreline resilience.

  [downtoearth.org.in]

  > "89% are medium or high risk"

- Rising sea levels and coastal structures like seawalls and jetties disrupt the delicate natural conditions required for surf breaks.

  [downtoearth.org.in]

  > "rising seas and shifting sands can fundamentally alter these conditions, while seawalls, jetties, and other coastal developments prevent beaches from naturally adapting."

In the image: A surfer riding a breaking ocean wave near the shore.

✓ 3 of 3 claims verified against sources · 1 source

downtoearth.org.in

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Rain Returns to Houston to Start the Week

Southeast Texas will experience the return of humidity, scattered showers, and storms from Monday through Wednesday evening.

- The weekend concludes with dry and pleasant weather across Southeast Texas.

  [fox26houston.com]

  > "The weekend ends beautifully on Sunday with warm and dry conditions across Southeast Texas."

- Humidity and rain chances are expected to increase starting Monday.

  [fox26houston.com]

  > "Humidity should creep back into Southeast Texas on Monday, and rain chances return, as well."

- Scattered showers and storms are forecasted to persist through Wednesday evening, with Tuesday experiencing the most widespread coverage.

  [fox26houston.com]

  > "Be ready for scattered showers and storms through Wednesday evening. Tuesday should see the most widespread coverage."

- A cold front is expected to impact the area by late next weekend. [fox26houston.com]

  > "We're looking for a cold front impacting next weekend, but most folks are going to enjoy those impacts!"

In the image: The image shows a broadcast screen for a completely different forecast in Jacksonville featuring dry weather and sunny skies on Monday, Tuesday, and Wednesday.

✓ 4 of 4 claims verified against sources · 2 sources

actionnewsjax.com · fox26houston.com

You engaged with 3 of 5 Climate change stories you saw

September Global Temperatures Continue to Exceed 1.5C Above Pre-Industrial Levels

Copernicus reports that September was the second-warmest globally, continuing a streak of months above the 1.5C threshold amid an intensifying El Niño.

- September ranked as the second-warmest globally and the second consecutive month exceeding 1.5C above pre-industrial levels.

  [northerndailyleader.com.au]

  > “September was the second-warmest September on record globally, with an average temperature of 16.27 degrees Celsius.”

- Prolonged dry conditions caused record-low river flows in parts of major European rivers.

  [northerndailyleader.com.au]

  > “Prolonged dry conditions resulted in record-low September river flows in parts of the Rhine, Danube, Vistula and Garonne-Dordogne.”

- The director of Copernicus stated that crossing the Paris climate target limit is now inevitable.

  [northerndailyleader.com.au]

  > “Crossing the 1.5-degree limit targeted in the Paris climate agreement was only a matter of time”

In the image: People wading into a public fountain in Paris to cool off during exceptionally high temperatures.

✓ 3 of 3 claims verified against sources · 1 source

northerndailyleader.com.au

You engaged with 3 of 5 Climate change stories you saw



Business growth drives high demand for Bermuda offices and hotels

International business growth and new developments like Luscar Place are fuelling an unrelenting demand for top-end commercial office space and hotel capacity in Bermuda.

- Penny MacIntyre states that there is an unrelenting demand for top-end office space driven by international business growth. [royalgazette.com]

  > "International business growth is fuelling demand for top-end office space and hotel capacity, a leading realtor said"

- Demand for space at Luscar Place shows market recovery and surpasses the re/insurance market's appetite. [royalgazette.com]

  > "demand for space at the new Luscar Place development on Pitts Bay Road represented a turnaround for the market"

- Construction on the seven-storey Luscar Place building started in 2025 and is anticipated to finish by July. [royalgazette.com]

  > "exclusive agent for the seven-storey building, for which construction began in 2025 and is expected to be completed by next July"

In the image: The image features Penny MacIntyre, partner at Rego Sotheby's International Realty, standing in an upscale modern office setting.

✓ 3 of 3 claims verified against sources · 1 source

royalgazette.com

You engaged with 1 of 2 Economy, business and finance stories you saw

Rising Sulfur Prices Squeeze Fertilizer and Industrial Manufacturing

Soaring sulfur costs driven by supply chain disruptions and geopolitical conflict threaten agriculture and energy sectors, prompting calls for increased domestic production.

- Sulfur prices have surged significantly over the past year, rising from over $200 a ton to more than $1,000 per ton. [theadvocate.com]

  > "Sulfur now costs more than $1,000 per ton, according to farmdoc; a year ago it was priced at over $200 a ton."

- The price spikes and supply issues are exacerbated by the U.S. war with Iran, which has stalled oil tankers in the Strait of Hormuz and hindered sulfur exports. [theadvocate.com]

  > "As the war stalls the passage of oil tankers through the Strait of Hormuz, sulfur exports have suffered and caused subsequent crises along the complex supply chain."

- Fertilizer manufacturer Mosaic Co. announced plans to lay off over 200 employees at its St. James Parish facilities due to financial pressures from sulfur prices. [theadvocate.com]

  > "Mosaic Co., a Tampa, Florida-based fertilizer company, announced in late August it would lay off more than 200 employees at its two St. James

> Parish facilities due to financial pressures from sulfur prices."

- Louisiana Agriculture Commissioner Mike Strain anticipates that these fertilizer pressures will result in fewer crop acres being planted in the United States. [theadvocate.com]

  > "Louisiana Department of Agriculture and Forestry Commissioner Mike Strain said he's expecting to see fewer acres of crops planted in the United States as a result of the pressures on the fertilizer industry."

In the image: The image shows yellow sulfur piled up in front of the Mosaic plant in St. James Parish, Louisiana, with corn stalks visible in the foreground.

✓ 4 of 4 claims verified against sources · 2 sources

nola.com · theadvocate.com

You engaged with 1 of 2 Economy, business and finance stories you saw

Ghana Finance Minister Highlights Economic Progress at IMF-World Bank Meetings

Dr Cassiel Ato Forson has showcased Ghana's economic stabilization efforts and announced a forthcoming New Economy blueprint for the 2027 budget.

- Finance Minister Dr Cassiel Ato Forson highlighted Ghana's economic progress during the IMF and World Bank meetings. [ghanamma.com]

  > "Dr Cassiel Ato Forson, has highlighted the country's economic progress at the ongoing International Monetary Fund"

- The government is preparing to introduce a New Economy blueprint as part of the upcoming 2027 national budget. [ghanamma.com]

  > "preparing to unveil what has been described as a 'New Economy' blueprint in the 2027 budget."

- The upcoming framework aims to boost productivity, expand economic opportunities, and enhance future growth prospects. [ghanamma.com]

  > "roadmap for strengthening productivity, expanding economic opportunities and improving the country's growth prospects."

✓ 3 of 4 claims verified against sources · 1 source

ghanamma.com

You engaged with 1 of 2 Economy, business and finance stories you saw

Northeast Heating Oil Prices Surge, Threatening Vulnerable Households

Record high heating oil prices in the Northeast are straining household budgets and driving up early demand for assistance as winter approaches.

- Heating fuel prices in Maine reached a record high in September, averaging over $6 a gallon and marking an 81% increase from the previous year. [wcbe.org] [ualrpublicradio.org]

  > “In Maine, heating fuel prices hit a record high in September at more than $6 a gallon on average, an 81% jump from last year.”

- Community organizations are experiencing unprecedented early-season demand for assistance, while federal funding remains unavailable until November. [wcbe.org][ualrpublicradio.org]

  > “We're seeing about the highest demand that we have seen for assistance and for services, and especially this early in the season.”

- In New York and Massachusetts, heating oil prices reached approximately $6.15 a gallon, representing a 70% increase compared to the previous year. [wcbe.org] [ualrpublicradio.org]

  > “In New York and Massachusetts, prices were about $6.15 a gallon. That's 70% more than it was last year at this time.”

- The tight supplies for diesel and heating oil stem from a loss of refining capacity caused by ongoing conflicts in Iran and Ukraine. [wcbe.org] [ualrpublicradio.org]

  > “So as a result, we're seeing very tight supplies for diesel and heating oil.”

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wcbe.org · ualrpublicradio.org

You engaged with 2 of 5 Energy stories you saw

OPEC Lowers Growth Forecast for 2026 While Raising Expectations for 2027

OPEC cut its 2026 global oil demand growth forecast for the fifth consecutive month while raising its outlook for 2027.

- OPEC reduced its 2026 global oil demand growth forecast by over 70 percent, noting a fifth straight monthly cut down to 400,000 barrels per day. [leadership.ng]

  > “global demand will grow by 400,000 barrels per day in 2026, down from 600,000 barrels per day in August”

- The organization's forecast for 2027 demand growth rose to about 2.4 million barrels per day. [leadership.ng]

  > “OPEC now expects demand to grow by about 2.4 million barrels per day next year”

- OPEC attributed the reshaping of energy usage to the ongoing conflict in the Middle East. [leadership.ng]

  > “OPEC says the conflict in the Middle East continues to reshape how energy is used.”

- Meanwhile, global oil benchmark Brent crude declined by 1.45 percent to USD 103.1 per barrel. [siasat.com]

  > “Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, declined 1.45 per cent to USD 103.1 per barrel.”

In the image: The image visually depicts barrels of crude oil and a pipe

pouring oil, which is not mentioned in the text.

✓ 4 of 4 claims verified against sources · 2 sources

leadership.ng · siasat.com

You engaged with 2 of 5 Energy stories you saw

Top Energy Executives Drop Off Riyadh Congress Agenda Following Attacks

Major energy company chiefs were removed from the schedule of the WPC Energy Congress in Riyadh after deadly attacks shook the capital.

- Several high-profile energy executives were removed from the official agenda for the WPC Energy Congress in Riyadh. [middle-east-online.com]

  > “Several top energy executives were dropped from the schedule of the WPC Energy Congress in Riyadh”

- The conference proceeded despite deadly attacks targeting the capital and claimed by Yemen's Houthis. [middle-east-online.com]

  > “as Saudi authorities pressed ahead with the event despite deadly attacks on the capital claimed by Yemen’s Iran-aligned Houthis.”

- A BP spokesperson cited travel disruption as the reason for the company's absence in person.

  [middle-east-online.com]

  > “Unfortunately, due to travel disruption, we are unable to be there in person.”

- Saudi Energy Minister Prince Abdulaziz bin Salman assured attendees that the kingdom prioritizes their protection.

  [middle-east-online.com]

  > “You know this country is safe and that we hold your protection at whole heart.”

✓ 4 of 4 claims verified against sources · 1 source

middle-east-online.com

You engaged with 2 of 5 Energy stories you saw

Understanding Overlapping Workplace Violations in Los Angeles Employment Cases

Employment disputes often involve multiple connected violations, requiring workers to understand how wage problems, discrimination, and retaliation fit together.

- Employment disputes in Los Angeles can involve complex combinations of unfair treatment, wage problems, harassment, or adverse action occurring within the same period. [lawfuel.com]

  > “An employee may experience unfair treatment, wage problems, harassment, or adverse action within the same period”

- Wage disputes frequently overlap with retaliation when workers face reduced hours or termination after reporting unpaid wages. [lawfuel.com]

  > “An employee may face reduced hours, unfavorable assignments, disciplinary action, or termination after requesting overtime pay or reporting unpaid wages.”

- Wrongful termination and discrimination claims often depend on evidence such as comments about protected characteristics and shifting employer explanations. [lawfuel.com]

  > “Comments about a protected characteristic, unequal treatment, shifting explanations, and close timing between a complaint and termination can help establish unlawful intent.”

- Building a credible case record requires preserving documents like pay stubs and text messages while avoiding the deletion of messages. [lawfuel.com]

  > “Employees should retain pay stubs, time records, schedules, personnel notices, emails, text messages, complaint details, and witness names.”

✓ 4 of 4 claims verified against sources · 1 source

lawfuel.com

Exploring: a Labour story outside your usual topics, to learn whether you want more



Pharmacogenomics Shifts Prescribing Away From One-Size-Fits-All Approaches

Using genetic data to select medication and dosages can help prevent adverse drug reactions and protect patients from dangerous toxicities.

- Traditional medical prescribing relies on a standard method that treats diagnosed conditions with a predetermined first-line drug. [pharmacytimes.com]

  > “Modern medicine has traditionally relied on a reactive, one-size-fits-all prescribing approach.”

- Standardized drug dosing ignores biological differences among individuals, which can cause treatment failures and adverse reactions.

  [pharmacytimes.com]

  > “Unfortunately, this overlooks the biological complexity of individual patients, often resulting in treatment failures or severe adverse drug reactions.”

- Pharmacogenomic guidance leverages genetic data so patients receive optimal drug selections and doses immediately.

  [pharmacytimes.com]

> “Pharmacogenomic-guided prescribing uses genetic data to protect patients from dangerous toxicities and get them the right drug at the right dose from the start.”

In the image: The image features a floating transparent capsule filled with golden droplets alongside a molecular DNA double helix.

✓ 3 of 3 claims verified against sources · 1 source

pharmacytimes.com

Exploring: a Biology and medical research story outside your usual topics, to learn whether you want more

You're caught up.

That's today's paper. Your next edition arrives tomorrow morning.